

FOR LUCIA

The Total Wife

Project summary — how the app was built

Live app: <https://jkgbafa.github.io/food-app-lucia/>

Source: <https://github.com/jkgbafa/food-app-lucia>

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What it became

A polished, installable web app for Lucia. It began as a “what should I cook for Josh” food app and grew into a full marriage companion structured around Dag Heward-Mills’ Model Marriage. It installs to a phone home screen as a real app, with the blue “THE TOTAL Wife” wordmark icon and a glowing ENTER entrance gate.

1 — Market research

Before building, roughly a dozen existing apps were surveyed (Crouton, Mela, Pestle, ReciMe, Samsung Food, Paprika and more). Nothing combined a spouse preference profile, one-tap meal planning and Instagram recipe import in a well-designed package — so building was justified. Crouton (Apple Design Award 2024) became the structural reference.

2 — The food app: Joshua’s Table

- Recipe gallery: 13 fully-written recipes from Josh’s saved Instagram collection plus an idea bank, searchable, with meal-type filter chips and a grid/list view toggle.
- One-tap weekly meal plan: breakfast/lunch/dinner for the whole week. Confirmed favorites weighted 3×, seafood structurally impossible, and lunches sometimes repeat last night’s dinner because Josh loves leftovers. Verified by an automated 1,050-slot test.
- Manual planning: tap any meal slot to search the dish list or type anything custom — with an automatic photo lookup (TheMealDB, free).
- Josh’s Guide: the complete likes/dislikes guide — very safe choices, every cuisine category, ingredient bank, and the don’t-make list.
- Instagram import: paste a link (or share directly from Instagram on Android) and it lands in the idea bank with an auto-fetched image.

3 — Design journey

The first Crouton-style build used emoji-and-gradient cards — rejected as cheap. It was rebuilt to match Airbnb / McDonald’s-concept / cookbook references: pure white, strictly monochrome, slim 1.5px line icons, black pill buttons, and real food photography — 45 free-license photos, each verified by eye on contact sheets so every dish and idea has an image.

4 — Accra shopping research

The Melcom, Shoprite and MaxMart catalogs were checked for hard-to-find ingredients. Ten recipes carry “Shopping in Accra” notes — e.g. buttermilk isn’t sold (use milk + lemon juice), no Buffalo sauce (hot sauce + butter), tahini is in MaxMart’s Lebanese section, and MaxMart’s Blue Dragon hoisin is confirmed seafood-free (never oyster sauce).

5 — The Total Wife remodel

- The seven roles from Model Marriage Ch. 13 are the home screen: A Christian, A Worker & Student, A Mother, A Sex Partner, A Cook, A Homekeeper, A Hostess & Companion — with Ch. 12's duties mapped under each role.
- Each role page: her duties, powerful one-liners to remember, messages to listen to (Dag Heward-Mills sermon links), and recommended reading.
- A Cook opens the entire food app.
- The six principles of a Total Wife close the home screen.
- From Your Husband — “Things I Need my Wife to Learn & Know”: the 1 Timothy 3:4–5 anchor, The Evil of Ignorance teaching with full definitions, the 11 times Paul fought ignorance, and the 11 things she must not be ignorant about — with the 17 characteristics of a Nursing Wife as its own special page (special non-public notes from Bishop Dag Heward-Mills).

6 — Infrastructure

Built with Next.js + Tailwind as a fully static site. Deployed first to Netlify, then moved to GitHub Pages at Josh's request (repo made public — required for free Pages). Installable PWA with an Android share-target so Instagram reels can be shared straight into the app.

Open items

- The repo and site are public — and now contain the Bishop's non-public notes and Josh's personal letter. Options: Netlify + private repo, or a PIN gate.
- The old Netlify copy (food-app-lucia.netlify.app) still exists and can be deleted.
- Attach “Those Who Are Proud” to mine real quotes into the Christian role page.
- AI auto-breakdown of Instagram reels into full recipes needs a small paid API backend — the plumbing is ready.

Made with love, for everyday use.